

# Charles Wautier

Product Software Engineer

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## Summary

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Product engineer with 12 years of experience across startups, freelancing, and scale-ups. End-to-end ownership from problem framing and product discovery to production systems, spanning backend, frontend, and infrastructure. Focused on turning ambiguous problems into clear, maintainable products aligned with user value.

## Experience

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### Projects, Independent

July 2024 – Apr 2026

- Built EUKnow, a platform for exploring MEP voting records and enabling users to cross-check them against political positions and public statements. Explored monetization paths and institutional partnerships. Put forward within a European Commission CERV project proposal in partnership with the Fondation Robert Schuman – [euknow.org](https://euknow.org)
- Explored cofounding opportunities via YC Co-founder Matching, interviewing and reflecting with founders on problem/solution fit.
- Produced and published a high-quality podcast episode on philosophy (research, scripting, recording, editing), as an experiment in structured idea communication – [charlesfm.net](https://charlesfm.net)
- Self-trained and practiced coaching with one coachee over a year.

### Interim CTO, ContentRadar (as freelancer)

Nov 2023 – June 2024

- Shaped product vision and strategy alongside the founding team.
- Built the MVP from the ground up in a team of two.
- Owned follow up features end-to-end — from UX and product definition through full-stack implementation.
- Hired and mentored a tech team, including the future CTO.

### Senior Developer, Shopify

July 2020 – June 2023

Worked in teams of 5–10 engineers across multiple projects.

- Shop Pay extension to merchants outside of Shopify (akin to PayPal or Apple Pay): Project management, design and research
- Marketplaces Checkout API — a stateful GraphQL checkout layer enabling marketplaces to integrate Shopify checkout: API design, tax handling.
- Migration of a product from PHP to Ruby while keeping both systems live: Preliminary research, technical documentation writing, implementation and coordination.
- Mentored junior engineers; gained experience navigating large-scale engineering, cross-team communication, and technical decision-making at a company of Shopify's size.

### Freelance

Oct 2019 – Apr 2020

- **Mercedes-Benz.io** (Oct–Dec 2019): Created the admin dashboard for the Bertha fueling app using Ruby on Rails and CSS BEM. Clarified and prioritised the need; delivered features incrementally; ensured ease of maintenance with proper testing, standard patterns and seamless integration in the existing infrastructure.
- **Elementr.** (Jan–Feb 2020): Bootstrapped the IT and built internal tools using AWS Lambda, CloudFormation, CloudWatch and Ruby.
- **Enpal** (Mar–Apr 2020): Made a funnel questionnaire posting using Salesforce, a Form Builder as a service and Ruby.

**Senior Software Engineer**, PubNative (now Verve)

June 2015 – Oct 2018

- Owned the Ruby on Rails & Angular app for background jobs and API services.
- Extended the high-throughput low-latency Go ad server.
- Managed the frontend team responsible for the client-facing UI and the company's ad-tag.
- Technologies: AWS, Kubernetes, Elasticsearch, Kibana, TICK Stack, Grafana, Logstash, Nginx, Docker.

**Ruby Developer**, Applift

Dec 2014 – May 2015

- Extended the Ruby on Rails & Angular application with new features.
- Collaborated with Product to find straightforward technical solutions.
- Got enrolled in PubNative, an internal project that turned into a proper company.

**Backend Web Developer**, Tame.it

July 2013 – Sept 2014

- Extended the core Ruby on Rails application providing real-time analytics for Twitter feeds.

## Projects

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**EUKnow** – [euknow.org](http://euknow.org) (Product)

Sept 2024 – present

Platform enabling citizens to verify alignment between political statements and actual EU Parliament voting records. Owned end-to-end from problem framing to implementation and business exploration. Engaged with journalists, institutions, and sector actors to assess use cases, traction, and monetization paths, including discussions with Fondation Robert Schuman around an EU Commission project. Built with Fly.io, Tailwind CSS, and ReactRouter v7.

**Mapping the abstract** – [charlesfm.net](http://charlesfm.net) (Podcast, Philosophical content)

Sept 2025 – present

Podcast exploring ideas with depth and structure. First episode on Phenomenology — researched, scripted, recorded, and edited independently as an experiment in rigorous idea communication.

**Coaching (Training practice)**

Jan 2025 – Jan 2026

Coaching is fascinating because it's about doing more with the same resources. It doesn't add answers from the outside — instead, it helps reorganize what's already there. With the right questions and structure, clarity emerges, perspectives shift, and actions become more aligned and fulfilling. Self-taught coaching out of curiosity, practicing with one coachee and exploring and refining the discipline along the way.

**WatchList (Product)**

June 2023 – Nov 2023

A fulfilling watchlist app: record who recommended a movie, rate the movies you want to see the most, and see ratings from top review sites in one go.

**GoRetro** – [goretro.charleswautier.com](http://goretro.charleswautier.com) (Product)

Apr 2020 – May 2020

An online retrospective tool implemented with Go, React, and Server Sent Events (SSE). 2-person project, responsible for the frontend.

**ghuser (Open-source contribution)**

Jan 2019 – Jan 2019

Open-source contribution. Augmented Node.js codebase to increase profile capacity leveraging GitHub's GraphQL.

**Pavlov (Product)**

Aug 2014 – Sept 2014

Online spaced-repetition service. Spaced repetition lets you learn and maintain knowledge by testing yourself on an exponential-backoff schedule. Pavlov lets you format content in a question/answer fashion and notifies you when it's time to recollect something.

**Domaine de la Roche Pilée (WordPress plugin)**

Jan 2012 – Mar 2012

Developed a WordPress plugin for managing public wine offers.

## Education

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**Karlsruhe Institute of Technology (KIT)**, Diplom-Informatiker in Computer Science and Informatics

Oct 2010 – Dec 2012

- **Courses:** Data Warehousing and Mining, Information Integration and Web-Portals, Workflow Management Systems, Cognitive Systems.
- **Diplom thesis:** Exploring collections in a semantic personal knowledge model – Design and implementation of an extension to the Personal Information Management software iMapping, providing a new way of browsing and interacting with personal knowledge-maps.
- **Side-Projects:** SpeedMaths, a solver for the (former) Facebook game SpeedMaths, written in C++ and Qt.

**Ensimag (National School of Computer Science and Applied Mathematics of Grenoble)**, Engineer Diploma in Computer Science and Information Systems Engineering  
Top-ranked French engineering school recruiting from preparatory classes.

Sept 2007 – Dec 2012

- **Courses:** Formal language theory, Algorithmic, Logic, Operations research, Probabilities, Software development & quality, Networks, Database conception, Computer architecture, Economy.
- **Projects:** Implemented a compiler of a Java subset in Ada 95; compared clustering algorithms for automatic classification of a musical resource set; implemented a UML subset editor in Java; designed a residence DB schema with normalized processes; implemented a virtual basic processor in VHDL; implemented a mini-pentium simulator in C; made a business-plan for a service of cultural recommendations and personal development.

**Istituto Europeo di Design**, Design and Visual Communications  
Design, Communication and Art propaedeutic year.

Sept 2009 – July 2010

- **Courses:** Cultural analysis, Communication, Art and Design history, Creative projects, Photography, Modelistic, Drawing, Color theory.
- **Achievements:** Produced a limited edition of a compact, lightweight hookah — original idea, design, 3D modelisation, realisation of wood prototypes and silicone moulds; co-designed the IED toolkit for running creative workshops still in use today, with the team led by José Corujeira.

## Skills

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**Programming Languages:** TypeScript, Go, Ruby

**Frameworks & Tools:** React, ReactRouterV7, GraphQL, Node.js, Ruby on Rails

**Infrastructure:** Terraform, AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL

**Languages:** English (Full Professional), Français (Native), German (Professional Working), Spanish (Limited Working)